

253 Make a cloud in a jar

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Three things make clouds—moist, warm air; coolness; and tiny particles in the air that make water vapor condense. This experiment uses hairspray to provide these particles.



What you need

- Jar with lid
- Aerosol hairspray
- ¼ cup hot water
- Ice cubes
- Blue food coloring



1 Fill the jar one-third full of hot water. Swirl it to warm the sides. Add the food coloring. Fill the upturned lid with ice.



2 Leave the ice cubes on top of the jar for a few seconds, then quickly lift the lid and squirt in some hairspray.

Escaping cloud



3 Put the lid back on. You should see a cloud start to form inside the jar. When it fills the jar completely, take off the lid and watch the cloud escape.



254 Find shapes and faces in clouds

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Clouds constantly change shape, which is why they're wonderful to see. Lie on your back and look up at the sky. What shapes or faces can you find?

Heart in the clouds